

Awards

Mouser receives Boeing Award

Mouser Electronics has received 2011 Boeing Silver Performance Excellence Award—a testament to the company's performance in key areas of reliability and service.

The Boeing Company issues the awards annually to recognise suppliers that have achieved superior performance. Mouser maintained a Silver composite performance rating for each month of the 12-month performance period, from October 1, 2010 to September 30, 2011.

Allied Electronics recognised for e-commerce distribution excellence

Allied Electronics has been conferred with the e-Commerce Distributor Excellence Award for 2011 by Bourns Inc. Bourns is a manufacturer and supplier of automotive sensors, circuit protection solutions, magnetic products, microelectronic modules, precision potentiometers, panel controls, encoders and resistive products. The award was given to Allied Electronics for the highest percentage growth from 2010 to 2011.

In only five months, 250,000 tablet PCs have been produced on the SIPLACE SMT platform.

Samsung plans smartphone plant in Mohali

Samsung is planning to establish a smartphone plant at Mohali IT Park in Chandigarh. According to a report, the company's top officials recently met Punjab chief minister Parkash Singh Badal and deputy chief minister Sukhbeer Singh Badal to seek adequate land to set up a multi-story office at the IT Park.

The under-construction airport in Mohali is cited as one of the many reasons that have lured Samsung to the city.

Solar Energy Corporation of India to push India-centric technology

In order to push development of India-specific technologies and products, Solar Energy Corporation of India plans to set up small, pilot power plants that have strong linkages with research and academic institutions. The state-run body is yet to share the locations of these power plants.

Commenting on the announcement, Anil Kakodkar, chairman of the corporation, said, "We need to put up demonstration solar power units, say, of 5 MW of two or three configurations, in a solar park and collect the data for scaling them up. The solar park will be close to R&D units and academic institutions."

Sankalp and KPIT partner for semiconductors

KPIT Cummins has carved out its semiconductor hardware solutions business in partnership with Sankalp Semiconductor, forming a wholly owned subsidiary named Sankalp & KPIT Semiconductor. KPIT Cummins will have a strategic minority stake in the parent Sankalp Semiconductor.

KPIT Cummins brings knowhow of services business scalability, experience in driving global operations, robust process management and market relationships to the new entity. Sankalp Semiconductor, on the other hand, will add its position as the preferred analogue and mixed-signal semiconductor design service provider, and its strength in developing talent to execute projects through an offshore development centre model.

Samsung combines S-LCD and Mobile Display units

Samsung Display has begun operating as a newly merged company with Samsung Mobile Display and S-LCD Corp. Oh-hyun Kwon, vice chairman and CEO of Samsung Electronics, is the chief executive officer of Samsung Display.

Through this merger, Samsung Display plans to expand its management efficiencies, while optimising the synergistic effects of its liquid-crystal display (LCD) and organic light-emitting diode (OLED) business initiatives.

The company also intends to combine OLED production technology with precision large-panel operations and seasoned supply chain management.

Toshiba to combine PC, tablet and TV design groups

Toshiba plans a series of functional reorganisations of its digital products business facilities in Japan. The aim is to enhance operating efficiency and performance of its digital products businesses, including the LCD TV business. Primarily, the company will be merging the design team for its Regza TVs into the same western Tokyo facility that houses its PC and tablet groups. By moving more production outside of Japan, the firm will increase its reliance on foreign third-party manufacturers.

Intel deal positive for ASML and semiconductor industry

ASML's customer co-investment programme, which includes a proposed 15 per cent equity participation by Intel, is positive for the Dutch-based lithography company on many fronts, and will have wider benefits for the semiconductor industry, according to Fitch Ratings.

The programme will see Intel take an initial 10 per cent stake, rising to 15 per cent subject to ASML shareholder approval for total cash proceeds of € 2.5 billion. Negotiations with Samsung and TSMC could lead to them taking strategic stakes of up to a further 10 per cent. Importantly, strategic owners will make material commitments to fund ASML's R&D for extreme ultraviolet and 450nm lithography, as well as advance purchase commitments for these technologies, over the next five years.

The announcement is a key development for ASML as it opens the way for significant minority ownership by some of the industry's largest manufacturers. Intel, Samsung and TSMC are ASML's largest customers and bellwether companies for capital spending and for dictating the pace at which lithography techniques can advance.

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